

19/03/2026

NEXTDC S7 – Preliminary Visual Advice.

1.0 Visual Context

1.1 The Site

The site is an irregularly shaped allotment with an approximate total area of 385,734m². It comprises two land parcels: Lot 13 in Deposited Plan 1302361 and Lot 7 in Deposited Plan 1225803.

The developable area is approximately 255,137m². This excludes 69,216m² in the southern portion of the site allocated for a regional stormwater detention basin, 54,727m² within the north-western panhandle, 5,317m² reserved for the future Archbold Road extension, and 1,337m² set aside for a future access road to the southern part of the site.

The site generally falls from around RL80.00 at the northern boundary to between RL60.00 and RL55.00 at the southern boundary, representing an overall elevation change of approximately 25 metres. Development Application DA-21-01557 includes approval for a substantial retaining wall in the southern portion of the site to accommodate an approximate level change of 15 metres.

Vehicle access is provided from Honeycomb Drive along the northern boundary. The proposal includes four vehicle access points: one providing direct access to the substation, one for staff vehicles, and a truck ingress and egress crossover to allow forward-facing vehicle movements.

Visually the site is largely devoid of built form apart from the Fulton Hogan Asphalt Plant in the northern corner of the site which includes several large industrial buildings, areas of hardstand and smaller surrounding buildings.

The majority of the site, including the developable area, is a modified landscape and characterised by undulating landform with areas of stockpiling and patches of bare ground surrounded by open turfed expanses. The southern part of the site includes remnant vegetation in the south-east corner and along the eastern border, as well as a tributary of Ropes Creek.

1.2 Surrounding Visual Context

North: the Bingo Eastern Creek Recycling Ecology Park is immediately north of Honeycomb Drive extension. Further north, separated by the M4 the visual environment is characterised by established low-density residential development, comprising detached brick dwellings set on moderate-sized suburban lots with consistent setbacks and landscaped front and rear yards. Built form is generally one to two storeys in height. To the north-west is warehouse and distribution development.

East: the built form to the east is characterised by large-scale, freestanding warehouse and distribution facilities set on expansive allotments, typically incorporating high-clearance internal spaces and ancillary two-storey office components. Buildings are typically arranged with generous setbacks to accommodate extensive hardstand areas, loading docks and heavy vehicle circulation. Wide road reserves are present and designed for freight movement with limited street tree planting, with vegetation in this area typically located around the perimeter of individual developments.

West: the land to the west is predominantly cleared and includes a transmission easement. Ropes Creek is located further west, with significant areas of native vegetation. The Erskine Park residential area is further west and is characterised by a consistent suburban built form typical of late 20th-century development in Western Sydney. Housing is predominantly single-storey with some two-storey detached dwellings, constructed from brick or rendered materials with pitched, tiled roofs. Dwellings are arranged on regular allotments with defined setbacks, driveways and garages.

South: the land to the south comprises cleared land, the electricity easement and an area of industrial and construction development surrounding Archibold Road. Further south beyond Lenore Drive is further areas of open land, Ropes Creek and tributaries and the TransGrid substation.

2.0 Heritage Items

The site is not identified as a local or State listed heritage item and is not within a heritage conservation area. The site is also not located close to any other identified items under any planning instrument.

3.0 Visual Catchment

Potential visibility of the proposal was determined by Urbis during fieldwork observations of the site from a range of distance classes (close, medium and distant views) and an indicative visual catchment from Google Earth.

PUBLIC DOMAIN

Potential views to the site and proposal from the public domain include:

- The western end of Honeycomb Drive that currently terminates at the asphalt plant, limiting the number of vehicles and pedestrians who would utilise the western end of the road
- The southern end of Archibold Road that currently terminates on the north-eastern corner of the asphalt plant
- A limited section of Archibold Road south of the site.
- Cul-de-sacs of Eastern Creek Drive and Telopea Place
- Limited areas of elevated locations to the south-east such as Walworth Road.

Key findings:

- Due to the underlying topography, development and presence of vegetation within the surrounding area, the visual catchment of the site and proposed works is constrained.

RESIDENTIAL PRIVATE DOMAIN

- Limited areas of residential development in Erskine Park west of the site may be possible from elevated locations and with second storey development. This would be dependent on building orientation, surrounding vegetation and neighbouring built form. Any potential views would be seen in a wide visual composition.
- Potential distant, limited dwellings south and south-east of the site, eg along Walworth Road.

4.0 Documented Views

There are no documented views to or across the site.

5.0 Recommended views for modelling

During fieldwork, high-resolution photographs were taken at standing eye height to document several key views with visibility of the proposal.

Upon inspection of the images, as well as on-site recorded observations, we have selected key locations to put forward for further analysis via photomontages (**P1 locations highlighted in green**) as well as secondary (**P2 locations**) if you wish to discuss additional photomontages.

As per the fee proposal, **5 views** have been recommended for modelling.

The photomontages will be simple block-model images to analyse the height, form and scale of the built form proposed as it will appear in the immediate and wider visual context. The photomontages will be used to inform the VIA.

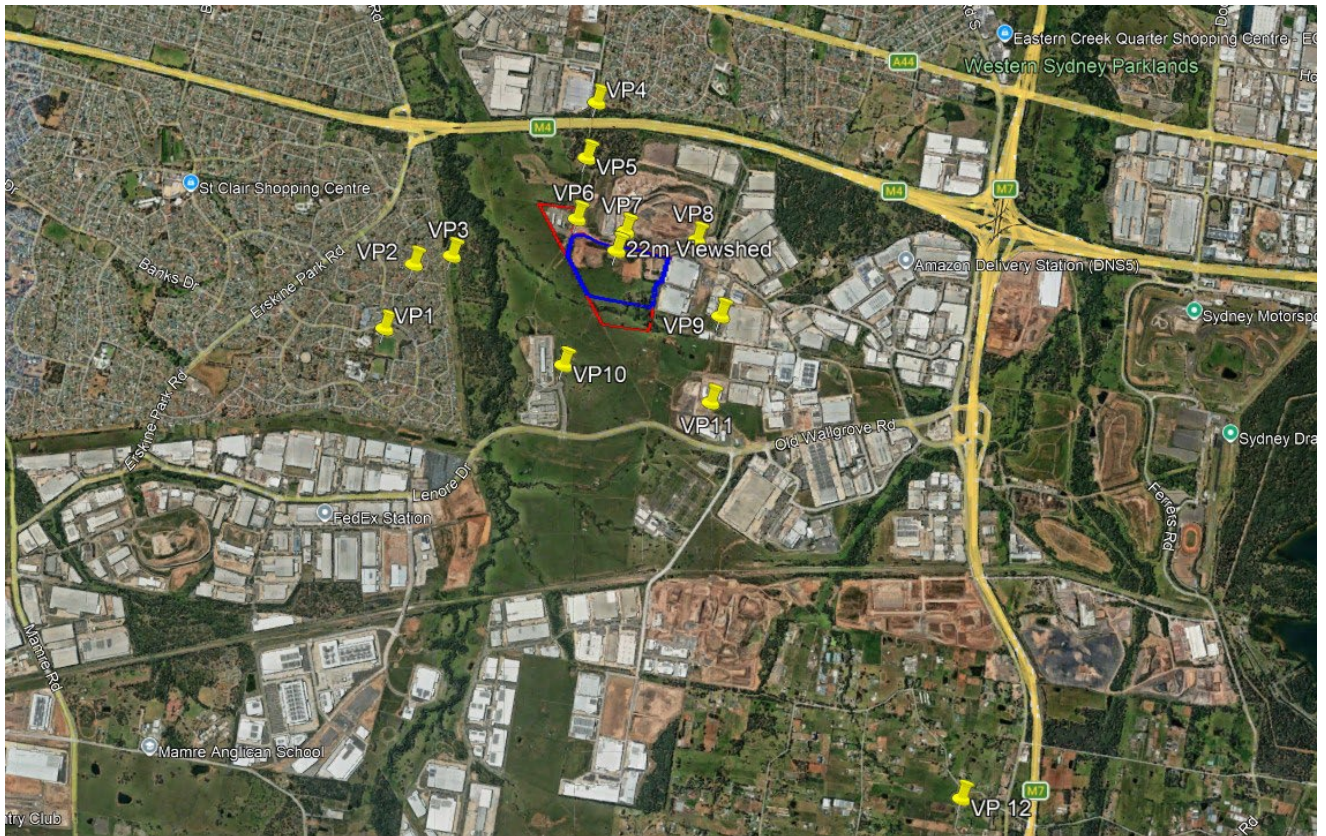


Figure 1 - Viewpoint locations.

Urbis Photo Reference	Urbis Report View Reference	Description	Priority 1 or 2
	View 1 IMG_5683	North-east view from Peppertree Reserve	1
	View 2 IMG_5695	View east from Fantail & Whistler Crescent Reserve	2
	View 3 IMG_5710	View east from undeveloped, vegetated land surrounding Ropes Creek, east of residential development	2
	View 4 IMG_5718	View south from Archibold Road bridge north of the site	2
	View 5 IMG_5722	View south from Archibold Road, north of Heinrich Close	1

	View 6 IMG_5736	View south-east from Honeycomb Drive cul-de-sac	2
	View 7 IMG_5756	View south from Honeycomb Drive along the site boundary	2
	View 8 IMG_5767	View west along Honeycomb Drive opposite 2 Hanson Place	1
	View 9 IMG_5775	View west from Grevillea Street	2
	View 10 IMG_5791	View north from Archibold Road, south of the site	1

	View 11 IMG_5806	View north-west from Telopea Place cul-de-sac	2
	View 12 IMG_4837	View north-west from opposite 78 Walworth Road	1

If you would like to discuss any aspect of this advice, please don't hesitate to contact me.

Kind regards



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